

Yuvaraj V - Off-Campus Interview Experience



About Juspay

Juspay is a Indian-based fintech established startup focused on providing seamless and secure payment experiences. It powers millions of transactions daily with its robust payment solutions used by top players in the Indian digital economy.

How I Applied

I got the recruiting information through LinkedIn and applied via Juspay's career site.

Reason to switch:

Job dissatisfaction during my 6-month internship period at Athenahealth.

Round 1: HR Telephone Confirmation

The HR called to inform me that I was shortlisted and asked whether I was open to proceeding, since I was currently interning at Athenahealth. I confirmed my interest and provided additional details such as education background, company name, and stipend. She said I'd receive a link for the online assessment test (Round 2).

Round 2: Online Assessment - 1 (MCQ, 45 mins)

Consisted of 15 MCQs from CS fundamentals (OOPs, DBMS, DSA, OS), and surprisingly, some basic +2 level Physics questions too.

I cleared this round and got a call the next day for the next DSA round.

Round 3: Online Assessment - 2 (DSA, 1h 30min)

Three DSA questions:

1. Easy: Prefix sum-based problem – solved completely.
2. Medium: Tree (non-BST) problem related to office hierarchy – partially solved (some TLE).

3. Hard: Couldn't complete – only half the cases passed.

Despite the tough round, I got selected for the next stage.

Round 4: Technical Interview - 1 (DSA Focused, 1h)

Conducted via Google Meet.

- 1st Problem: Rainwater trapping – I already knew the approach, so it went very well.
- 2nd Problem: Matrix distance calculation among same numbers – started with brute force, then optimized it using a derived equation. Interviewer was impressed, but due to network issues, we couldn't continue.

Later, I received a call saying I was selected for the next round.

Round 5: Hackathon - Part A (3h)

A 3-hour online DSA round.

Only one problem related to M-ary Tree – a very common one in Juspay interviews. I was well-prepared and solved it.

Got a call after a week that I qualified for Part B.

Round 6: Hackathon - Part B (8h)

A full-day 1-on-1 hackathon.

A company buddy was assigned to assist. They asked questions based on my previous M-ary tree solution and also pushed me to implement concurrency and threading concepts. Though syntactically relaxed, they expected high-level knowledge.

Round 7: System Design Interview (Turning Point)

This was the toughest round.

Questions asked:

- **System design scenario:**
In your real-time IPL auction project, how would you ensure minimal latency if 1 user from the US and 1 from India are playing?
(I mentioned CDN and related solutions, but he expected deeper, real-time focused strategies.)

- **DSA Problem:**
 "Assume you have an array but no built-in way to get its length. How will you find it?"
 (I gave the binary search for infinite array approach – he was satisfied.)
- **Theoretical questions:**
 - What is a clock cycle? (Expected a basic, intuitive answer – I couldn't answer well.)
 - How does a compiler work?
 - Describe the entire data transmission process from one network to another (I struggled here).
- **Puzzle:**
 21 sticks puzzle – I solved it correctly.
- **DSA Theoretical:**
 - Queue vs Stack
 - How Priority Queue is implemented
- **Other** **Topics:**
 Asked about AI/ML project experience.

Despite some good points, I couldn't impress him in many areas. He seemed very knowledgeable in multiple domains.

Role Change & Compensation Difference

Because of my average performance in this round, though I originally applied for an **SDE role**, they offered me the **Product Engineer - 1 (PE-1)** role considering my problem-solving skills.

After discussing with a few seniors, I came to know that the primary distinction between the two roles is compensation:

- **SDE Role:** ₹27 LPA CTC with ~₹17 LPA base
- **Product Engineer Role:** ₹21 LPA CTC with ~₹14 LPA base

Both roles are quite similar in responsibilities and learning opportunities.

Final Round: HR Discussion

A phone call where they confirmed:

- Relocation readiness
- Role clarification
- Notice period details
- Joining date

Finally, they confirmed my offer for the **Product Engineer - I** role.

Such long and intense processes are only followed by a few companies like Juspay. Don't worry guys, on-campus processes are usually simpler and shorter.

If you have any questions, feel free to contact me:

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